

Freelancer Client Onboarding Kit: 6 Done-for-You Templates

RenWork Digital Products

Template 1: The "Welcome & Next Steps" Email

****Subject:**** You're in! [Project Name] Kickoff Details

Hi [Client First Name],

Congratulations! I'm thrilled to officially welcome you to [Project Name]. It's a pleasure to have you on board, and I've already started mapping out the initial strategy based on our last call.

To ensure we hit the ground running, here is exactly what happens next:

1. ****Access & Setup:**** I will send you a secure link to our project management hub by [Day/Time].

Please review the attached "Client Onboarding Checklist" and complete the items marked with a "Client Action" tag within the next 48 hours.

2. ****Questionnaire:**** Please fill out the Project Kickoff Questionnaire by [Date]. This is the most critical step; the depth of your answers directly influences the quality of the first draft.

3. ****Asset Collection:**** I've created a shared drive folder for all brand assets (logos, fonts, images). Please upload anything you have now so I can begin the design/strategy phase.

I will send you a personal update on [Day] to confirm we are on track. If you have any immediate questions, simply reply to this email.

Let's build something great.

Best,

[Your Name]

[Your Title]

Template 2: Project Kickoff Questionnaire (20 Questions)

****Instructions:**** Please answer these questions thoroughly. Use bullet points if preferred. The more detail you provide, the fewer revision cycles we will need later.

****1. Core Goals****

1. What is the primary business objective of this project? (e.g., lead generation, brand awareness, sales conversion)
2. What does "success" look like for this specific deliverable?
3. Are there any secondary goals we should keep in mind?
4. What is the single biggest pain point this project needs to solve for your customers?

****2. Audience & Market****

5. Who is our ideal customer? (Be specific: age, job title, interests, location)
6. What are their top three frustrations or challenges?
7. What is the "dream outcome" they want to achieve?
8. Who are two competitors you admire? Why do you like their approach?
9. Who are two competitors you dislike? Why?

****3. Brand Voice & Identity****

10. If your brand were a person, how would you describe their personality in three words?
11. What is the tone of voice we should maintain? (e.g., professional, witty, authoritative, friendly)
12. Are there specific words, phrases, or slang your brand never uses?
13. Do you have existing brand guidelines (logo, colors, fonts)? If yes, please link them.

****4. Deliverables & Scope****

14. Can you list the exact deliverables expected at the end of this phase?
15. Are there any existing assets (blogs, brochures, videos) I should reference for style or content?
16. Who is the final decision-maker for approvals?
17. What is the deadline for the first draft?
18. What is the final deadline for the completed project?

****5. Metrics & Logistics****

19. How will we measure the success of this project post-launch? (e.g., click-through rate, sales, engagement)
20. What is the best way to reach you for urgent matters? (Phone, email, Slack)

Template 3: Onboarding Checklist

****Client Actions (Due: [Date])****

- * ☐ Complete the Project Kickoff Questionnaire.
- * ☐ Upload all brand assets (logos, font files, brand book) to the shared drive.
- * ☐ Provide login credentials for relevant tools (e.g., CMS, Analytics, Social Media) via a password manager.
- * ☐ Confirm the final project timeline and milestones.
- * ☐ Introduce the project to internal stakeholders who need to provide feedback.

****Freelancer Setup (Due: [Date])****

- * ☐ Create the project workspace in [Project Management Tool].
- * ☐ Set up communication channels (e.g., Slack channel or dedicated email alias).
- * ☐ Send the contract and invoice for the initial payment.
- * ☐ Conduct a 15-minute "Getting to Know You" call if not yet done.
- * ☐ Create the initial content/design brief based on questionnaire responses.
- * ☐ Schedule the first check-in meeting.

Template 4: Communication Expectations One-Pager

****Response Times****

- * ****Urgent (Contract/Technical):**** Response within 4 business hours.
- * ****Standard (Feedback/Updates):**** Response within 24 business hours.
- * ****Non-Urgent (General Questions):**** Response within 48 business hours.
- * ***Note:** "Business Hours" are defined as 9 AM - 5 PM, [Time Zone], Monday through Friday.*

****Feedback Process****

1. ****Consolidated Feedback:**** Please consolidate all feedback into a single document or comment section. Avoid sending feedback via multiple scattered emails or texts.
2. ****Specificity:**** Instead of "I don't like it," please say "The headline feels too aggressive; can we make it softer?"
3. ****Feedback Window:**** We allow a 5-business-day window for feedback on each milestone. If no feedback is received by the deadline, the work will be considered approved.

****Revision Policy****

- * This project includes [Number] rounds of revisions per deliverable.
- * ****Revision Round 1:**** Major structural or content changes.
- * ****Revision Round 2:**** Fine-tuning, copy edits, and minor design adjustments.

- * **Additional Revisions:** Any requests beyond the included rounds will be billed at an hourly rate of \$[Rate]/hour.
- * **Clarification:** Changing the entire direction of the project after approval is considered a new scope, not a revision.

Template 5: Project Timeline Template

Phase 1: Discovery & Strategy

- * **Start:** [Date]
- * **End:** [Date]
- * **Activities:** Questionnaire review, competitive analysis, initial strategy draft.
- * **Milestone:** Strategy Document Approved.
- * **Client Review:** [Date] (24h turnaround)

Phase 2: Creation/Production

- * **Start:** [Date]
- * **End:** [Date]
- * **Activities:** Drafting, design, development, or video editing.
- * **Milestone:** First Draft Delivered.
- * **Client Review:** [Date] (5 days for feedback)

Phase 3: Refinement & Finalization

- * **Start:** [Date]
- * **End:** [Date]
- * **Activities:** Incorporating client feedback, final QA, formatting, and optimization.
- * **Milestone:** Final Deliverable Approved.
- * **Client Review:** [Date] (48h turnaround)

Phase 4: Delivery & Handoff

- * **Start:** [Date]
- * **End:** [Date]
- * **Activities:** Final file transfers, documentation, and a 30-minute handoff call to train your team.
- * **Milestone:** Project Complete.

Template 6: Scope Creep Response Script

Scenario A: The "Small" Request

Client: "Hey, while you're at it, can you just quickly update the color scheme to blue?"

Response:

"Hi [Client], I appreciate the suggestion. Changing the color scheme involves updating [X] files and ensuring accessibility contrast, which is a new task outside our current scope. I can absolutely do this for you! Let's treat this as a separate line item. I'll send you a quote for approximately [Time Estimate] hours at my standard rate of \$[Rate]/hr. If you'd like to proceed, just reply with 'Yes, please,' and I'll add it to the next invoice."

Scenario B: The Major Pivot

Client: "Actually, before you start, I think we need to change the entire target audience from B2B to B2C."

Response:

"Hi [Client], I'm glad you brought this up now. Changing the target audience from B2B to B2C fundamentally alters our strategy, messaging, and design approach. This is a significant change that resets our current progress.

To move forward with the B2C approach, we will need to:

1. Pause the current work.
2. Re-run the discovery phase for the new audience.
3. Update the contract to reflect the new scope and timeline.

I can send you a revised proposal for the B2C strategy by [Date]. Would you like me to proceed with that?"

Scenario C: The "Just One More Thing" During Revisions

Client: "The draft is good, but can you also add a new section about our history?"

Response:

"Thanks for the feedback! I've noted the adjustments to the existing sections. However, adding a new section about your company history is a new content creation task,